

## Alton Towers: The Guide 2026

| <b>Average Hourly Throughput</b> |                      |
|----------------------------------|----------------------|
| Galactica                        | 900 riders an hour   |
| Nemesis Reborn                   | 1,400 riders an hour |
| Oblivion                         | 1,900 riders an hour |
| Rita                             | 800 riders an hour*  |
| Runaway Mine Train               | 1,062 riders an hour |
| Spinball Whizzer                 | 950 riders an hour   |
| Thirteen                         | 1,400 riders an hour |
| The Smiler                       | 1,100 riders an hour |
| Toxicator                        | 500 riders an hour   |
| Wickerman                        | 952 riders an hour   |

\*based on a calculated estimate

| <b>Average Queue Times (all time)</b> |            |
|---------------------------------------|------------|
| The Smiler                            | 46 minutes |
| Wickerman                             | 46 minutes |
| Thirteen                              | 34 minutes |
| Rita                                  | 33 minutes |
| Galactica                             | 32 minutes |
| Spinball Whizzer                      | 29 minutes |
| Runaway Mine Train                    | 24 minutes |
| Oblivion                              | 22 minutes |
| Nemesis Reborn                        | 21 minutes |
| Toxicator                             | 14 minutes |

View my ranked rollercoasters for a guide on what to ride and what to avoid:

<https://rollercoasters.jakublabs.xyz>

| Average Queue Times (2026) |             |
|----------------------------|-------------|
| The Smiler                 | 41 minutes  |
| Wickerman                  | 42 minutes  |
| Thirteen                   | 33 minutes  |
| Rita                       | 31 minutes  |
| Galactica                  | 36 minutes  |
| Spinball Whizzer           | 28 minutes  |
| Runaway Mine Train         | 19 minutes* |
| Oblivion                   | 24 minutes  |
| Nemesis Reborn             | 23 minutes  |
| Toxicator                  | 12 minutes  |

\*runaway mine train has been closed for the majority of season opening

| Maximum Time worth Queueing for |                                                                                                                 |
|---------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| The Smiler                      | 70 minutes                                                                                                      |
| Wickerman                       | 45 minutes                                                                                                      |
| Thirteen                        | 45 minutes                                                                                                      |
| Rita                            | 45 minutes                                                                                                      |
| Galactica                       | 40 minutes                                                                                                      |
| Spinball Whizzer                | 29 minutes                                                                                                      |
| Runaway Mine Train              | 15 minutes                                                                                                      |
| Oblivion                        | 60 minutes                                                                                                      |
| Nemesis Reborn                  | Id queue forever for this  |
| Toxicator                       | 20 minutes                                                                                                      |

Average queues do not factor in peak and off peak days. Due to there being more off peak days than on peak, the average times do not factor in peak times. Expect queues around 60 to 70 minutes at the top for most rides during peak times. (rides can and have gone above 100)

| Ride Priority Order                                                              |
|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| What priority you should ride the rollercoasters based on quality and queue time |
| The Smiler                                                                       |
| Galactica                                                                        |
| Nemesis Reborn                                                                   |
| Wickerman                                                                        |

|          |
|----------|
| Oblivion |
| Rita     |
| Thirteen |

Time till ride = Walking to ride time + Queue Time

Make sure you chose the ride with the lowest time till ride when you are looking for a ride, you never know when its queues will spike. Take advantage of low ride times.

Nemesis Tip:

Nemesis on 10 minute queue is essentially walk on.

Nemesis on 5 minute queue is definitely walk on

Nemesis *usually* advertises a higher wait time than it actually is

### **Picking a day guide**

Picking a day to go is the most important thing. You can usually see days that are expected to be busy by ticket prices. E.g. £32 being off peak days and £40 being very busy days. You can also check [crowd calendar](#) to see the forecasted visitor capacity.

| <b>Avoid these days</b>   |                                                                  |              |
|---------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------|
| Bank Holidays             | Half terms                                                       | School trips |
| Towards the end of season | Any day where people would have free time to go to Alton Towers. |              |

### **Tip for if you are scared of rollercoasters**

get on the fucking ride

| Why you shouldn't be scared of rollercoasters                                                                                                                                                                                                                            |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                               |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                  |
|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| They are fun                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                             | The most dangerous part of a theme park is getting there.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                     | You are 16x more likely to win the lottery than to die on a rollercoaster                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                        |
| 68x more likely to die on a plane than on a rollercoaster                                                                                                                                                                                                                | 2x more likely to die on a plane than to even be injured on a rollercoaster                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                   | Here is the crazy one, you are 8,064,516 times more likely to die in a car than on a rollercoaster                                                                                                                                                                                                                                               |
| If that doesn't tell you the safety margin then I don't know what does                                                                                                                                                                                                   |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                               |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                  |
| Rollercoasters are short. It will all be over soon                                                                                                                                                                                                                       | The fear only lasts until you begin picking up speed and the ride properly starts. Fear gets entirely replaced with adrenaline and/or dopamine                                                                                                                                                                                                | Your restraint physically cannot open during a ride. For a restraint to open it needs to be powered. Only place where it can be powered is at the station. Even if power fails you are locked in.                                                                                                                                                |
| A rollercoaster closing is not a sign of an unsafe ride. It is actually the ride doing its job and preventing operations if even the slightest thing feels off. A rollercoaster will literally shut down if a sensor reports data back a millisecond later than expected | The Smiler accident was completely human error. The safety system did exactly what it was designed to do. Poor training caused staff to override the safety systems and cause the accident. Nothing like this will ever happen again due to the fact that now it is now impossible to override the safety system without confirming its safe. | You physically cannot rollback on a lift hill. The clicking sound you hear as you go up is the anti-rollback pin. If the lift hill somehow disengages with the train, the anti-rollback pin will hook into a section of track and hold the train there. With this system it is physically impossible for a train to go backwards on a lift hill. |

|                                                                                                                                                                                    |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                    |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                 |
|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <p>If the rollercoaster for whatever reason loses power. All brakes default to closed, meaning the ride will stop when it is safe to do so.</p>                                    | <p>Block zones mean that 2 trains cannot be in the same section of track at the same time. A train is not allowed to enter a section of occupied track, as it will be stopped by the system. Think of it as trains on the railway having red signals if a train is up ahead, but here it is fully automatic.</p>                                                                                                                                                                                                   | <p>A rollercoaster cannot get stuck upside down on a loop or twist. Physics mate.</p>                                                                                                                                                           |
| <p>Not all rollercoasters have seatbelts. They are not required, and even if they do, they don't bring any additional safety, its just a visual affirmation for peace of mind.</p> | <p>Lap bars are not more dangerous. A seat is shaped differently for lap bar restrains, such as that the lap bar will pinch you into the seat. The only difference between a lap bar and an over the shoulder restraint is the point it secures you at. There is literally no difference in terms of what's safer. Hyperia uses lap bars and that has a 236 foot vertical drop and 2 inversions. TL;DR: A restraint is based on the design of the ride, seat and train, therefore whatever a ride has is safe.</p> | <p>The fear of rides comes from your perception of them. Once you get on it, you will realise its not scary, and in fact it is a very fun thing. The hardest part of riding a rollercoaster is getting on. After that it will all work out.</p> |

TL;DR: if my bitch ass got over my fear of rollercoasters by just getting on the tallest thing I saw at Six Flags (Superman the ride at 208 feet), then so can you.

## Public Transport Guide

### By Train

EMR runs trains to Uttoxeter and Stoke on Trent. Uttoxeter is the ideal station to get off at when you go to Alton Towers. Trains to Uttoxeter go from Crewe, Nottingham, Derby, Newark, Lincoln and more. Check TrainPal for departure times from your local station.

### By Bus

Bus is a little bit of a shithole because there's very few bus services that run (2 that will get you there before park close)

**Uttoxeter:** 7:43am (arrival at 9:47am) and 11:53am (arrival at 12:38pm)

**Stoke on Trent:** 8:29am (arrival at 9:47am) and 10:24am (arrival at 12:38pm)

No buses run on Sundays, and there are no direct return buses to Uttoxeter.

**To Stoke on Trent:** 5:26pm (arrival at 6:35pm), you can get off at Cheadle and catch a bus to Uttoxeter, but it's a long wait in the middle of some shithole.

### By foot (lol?)

Unless you like walking, I do not recommend this, it is a 3 hour walk from Uttoxeter, and you are traversing through absolutely nothing but hills, grass, forest and shitholes. There is approximately 689 feet of upwards elevation and 374 feet of downwards elevation on the way there.

### Overall Recommendation

I recommend getting the train to Stoke on Trent and to arrive there before 8:29am to catch the bus there. You can then return on the 5:26pm bus back to the station where you can go back home on train.

Use Google Maps to plan transport.

Yes public transport to Alton Towers is ass, I'd avoid it at all costs unless you don't have any other way of getting there.

## Merlin Annual Pass

If you are planning on grinding Alton Towers (like me), then I recommend you get a Merlin Annual pass. They start at around £139 and they give you access to Alton Towers (as well as other parks too) all year round\*

I personally have the Platinum Pass as it is the best value.

### Compare Annual Passes

| Essential Pass                                                                                                                                        | Gold Pass                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                             | Platinum Pass                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                      |
|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>- 339 days of entry all year</li><li>- Discounted exclusion date tickets</li><li>- 10% off Fast Track</li></ul> | <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>- 364 days of entry all year</li><li>- Excludes Alton Towers Fireworks</li><li>- Free Parking</li><li>- 20% off Shops and Restaurants</li><li>- Up to 50% off family and friends tickets</li><li>- 10% off Fast Track</li></ul> | <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>- No exclusion dates</li><li>- 20% off Shops and Restaurants</li><li>- Up to 50% off family and friends' tickets</li><li>- 4 free tickets for friends and family</li><li>- Free one-time fast track per visit.</li><li>- Free golf</li></ul> |
| Price: £139                                                                                                                                           | Price: £239                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                           | £299                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                               |
| Saved per trip: Up to £32<br>- Ticket                                                                                                                 | Saved per trip: Up to £45<br>- Ticket & Free Parking                                                                                                                                                                                                                  | Saved per trip: Up to £65<br>- Ticket, Free Parking & One Shot Fast Track                                                                                                                                                                                                          |
| 5 trips and you have your money back in value                                                                                                         | 6 trips and you have your money back in value*                                                                                                                                                                                                                        | 5 trips and you have your money back in value*                                                                                                                                                                                                                                     |
| *counting if you use your annual pass perks and original ticket prices may vary                                                                       |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                       |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                    |
| Also does not count friends and family money saved, money saved on discounts.                                                                         |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                       |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                    |